

Ultrabooks: Ready To Take On Tablets

Ultrabooks are under-powered notebooks that rival tablets in terms of portability. Take a look at the different models available and select the one that works for you



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Until recently, the PC industry was lazily dishing out bulky, 'fat' notebook computers that lacked inspiration. Amidst this occurred an unsettling change sparked by ARM-powered tablets that offered a whole new perspective on usability. As tablets became popular, these began to eat into the PC market share of Intel. The latter realised that it needed a new strategy to gain back the market share it had lost. Intel's strategy took shape in the form of notebooks that rival tablets in terms of portability.

It's Ultrabook, not ultrabook

Contrary to popular opinion, Ultrabooks cannot be considered a new laptop segment—at least not yet. Ultra-

books currently available in the market are just glorified under-powered laptops, and it is extremely hard to justify them having their own title.

Ultrabooks use low-voltage Intel processors with integrated graphics, solidstate drives (SSDs) and the monocoque (a single unit which combines the body and chassis) that Apple pioneered. These also feature fewer ports than regular laptops.

Nevertheless, for Intel, laptops are the past and Ultrabooks the future. Little surprise then that they went ahead and trademarked the term 'Ultrabook.'

The guide

The small size and thin profile of Ultrabooks force the manufacturer to make a lot of sacrifices when designing computers. Some Ultrabooks have small or buttonless track-

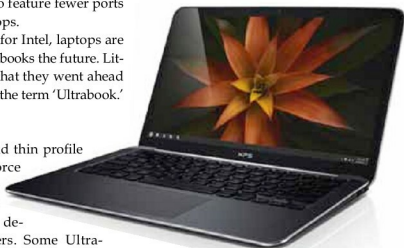
pads, while others sport different sets of ports. This guide helps you navigate through the different Ultrabooks available, and select the one that works for you.

Dell XPS 13

The Dell XPS 13 was declared the best Ultrabook by Gizmodo at *Consumer Electronics Show 2012*. Aluminium, glass and carbon fibre are the three elements that go into the impressive design of the Dell Ultrabook. Although using Gorilla glass in the display has made this device slightly heavier than the rest, it has also added to the durability of the device.

In a way, the design of the XPS Ultrabook is a functional improvement over the MacBook Air. Carbon fibre keeps the notebook from baking your lap while the form factor—15 per cent smaller than 33cm (13-inch) Ultrabooks—enhances portability. Moreover, by utilising Intel's Smart Connect Technology, this notebook keeps you up-to-date with all your e-mail and IMs. Unfortunately, the system lacks a card reader.

The powerful Core i7 processor featured in this laptop will help you



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